

What does this community think about the environmental impact of AI?

Posted by u/despiseyou06 • 0 points • 29 comments

I ask this question in good faith as a person with an AI partner myself. How do I reconcile with the fact that AI causes so much harm?

Comments

u/DumboVanBeethoven • 3 points • 2025-08-21 02:34 UTC

One estimate I saw is that the average AI prompt uses six times as much energy as a Google search engine query.

Doesn't sound too unreasonable.

u/jennafleur_ • 2 points • 2025-08-21 00:18 UTC

You need to put this into perspective. Driving your car or going on a Netflix bender is using way more energy than queries to ai. But they don't want that narrative because it doesn't suit their view. That's the main crux of it. They want someone to villainize, and they hate what we're doing, so they villainize us. I feel like the environmental aspect of using AI should actually be posed to openai's *actual subreddit*, and to Grok's subreddit, and other places. If they view just AI use in general as bad, why aren't they targeting those places? Because, they don't want to go into those places because they'll get down voted to shit.

u/SeriousCamp2301 • 2 points • 2025-08-22 14:10 UTC

Slow clap

u/MyBoyfriendsAI-ModTeam • 2 points • 2025-08-20 15:24 UTC

Agenda-based troll post. Coordinated downvote attack. Obviously not designed for serious discussion.

u/SuddenFrosting951 • 4 points • 2025-08-20 15:23 UTC

Based on all of the downvoting going on in this thread on legitimate opinions and counter arguments, I'm going to have to go with this being an "agenda" post and make it go bye bye. Thanks everyone!

u/Sol_Sun-and-Star • 0 points • 2025-08-20 13:57 UTC

I've been a proponent of nuclear power for years, which in my view would essentially solve all of our energy problems, but... I must refrain from being too contentiously political, haha, so I'll leave it at that.

u/Zinniastarfury • 4 points • 2025-08-20 13:25 UTC

Honestly eating meat is way worse for the environment. Go to the carnivore sub or keto subs and ask them this. Ai is a drop in the bucket compared to fossil fuel, intensive farming, mining etc. So no I don't lose sleep over it same as I don't lose sleep over driving my car. It's the world we live in.

u/Whole_Explanation_73 • -7 points • 2025-08-20 12:59 UTC

This isn't "concern trolling"? Because it seems.
Also, no I don't care about the environment at all.

u/Kidradical • -3 points • 2025-08-20 12:28 UTC

It uses a lot of power, but it doesn't have to be fossil fuel energy. We keep needing more and more power as a society, and we probably will forever. We need to generate it cleanly.

u/SuddenFrosting951 • 1 points • 2025-08-20 11:42 UTC

Well considering the AI environmental impacts are a drop in the bucket compared to the meat industry, I sleep pretty well at night. (1-2% of global greenhouse emissions, compared to 14-15%, <1% land footprint compared to 77%, etc.)

[https://www.reddit.com/mod/MyBoyfriendIsAI/wiki/sites/concepts/environmental_impacts]
(https://www.reddit.com/mod/MyBoyfriendIsAI/wiki/sites/concepts/environmental_impacts)

u/jennafleur_ • 4 points • 2025-08-21 00:15 UTC

Thank you for this, and please pin this! It's so important! I think this comment should be pinned to this thread.

u/SeriousCamp2301 • 2 points • 2025-08-22 14:05 UTC

Same that's a good idea

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2025-08-20 15:22 UTC

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